

February

15



1932

Going for gold

US athlete Eddie Eagan won Olympic gold with the bobsleigh team at Lake Placid, USA. As he had won gold for boxing at the Olympics in 1920, he became the only person to win golds at the summer and winter games in different sports.

1943

Wartime women

A poster of a female worker saying “We Can Do It!” was put up on the walls of Westinghouse factories in the USA during World War II. Originally a call for employees to work harder, the poster later became a symbol for empowered women.



Also on this day

1942 Thousands of Allied soldiers became prisoners of war after the key Pacific base of Singapore fell to Japanese forces in World War II.

2001 The first draft of the complete human genome – the set of instructions that make up our genetic code – was published by scientists.

2013 A meteor blew up with the force of a nuclear explosion over Chelyabinsk, Russia, destroying buildings and injuring 1,500 people.

Born this day

1820 Susan B Anthony, US women’s rights activist. She was an influential social reformer and the president of the National American Woman Suffrage Association.

The Canadian flag

Canada’s official national flag was raised for the first time on Parliament Hill in Ottawa. The maple leaf at its centre has been a national symbol for centuries.

1965

